Valkyries Bring the Trophy Home With a Bay Area Parade

From: CBC World Mined: 2026-11-05 5 min read

The Golden State Valkyries brought their championship home in style on Wednesday. The newest WNBA champions celebrated with fans in Oakland and San Francisco, and the players joked that fans should take the day off to join them. There was dancing, champagne, team colours and plenty of high-fives, and of course the team **mascot**, Vi. Vi is a raven named Violet, a bird often seen as a sidekick to the Valkyries in Norse **mythology**, according to the team website. The celebration began at Oakland's Jack London Square, near the team's downtown practice facility, where the players posed for photos onstage with the championship trophy. Then they hopped on a ferry across San Francisco Bay and began the parade from San Francisco's Ferry Building. The route finished near Oracle Park, home of the San Francisco Giants. Fans turned out in team colours from head to toe, cheering from the street and even from a rooftop as the parade rolled past. Guard Tiffany Hayes celebrated from a **double-decker** bus, while centre Kiah Stokes joined the kickoff rally in Oakland. The title caps a remarkable rise. Golden State was granted an **expansion franchise** three years ago, and team owner Joe Lacob promised a championship within five years. Led by coach Natalie Nakase, the team delivered the title in Year 2, after becoming the first **expansion franchise** to reach the playoffs in its first year in 2025. The parade even had a running joke. After Atlanta beat the Valkyries in Game 3, Atlanta player Angel Reese **taunted** the Valkyries' bench with a hand gesture for "too small." The Valkyries turned the taunt into a celebration, and guard Juste Jocyte flashed the gesture to the fans during the parade.

Word Treasure

mascot -- A mascot is a character or animal that represents a team.
franchise -- A franchise is a team that is part of a sports league.
expansion -- An expansion team is a brand-new team added to a league.
taunted -- To taunt someone is to tease them in a mean way.
mythology -- Mythology is a set of old stories about gods and heroes.
double-decker -- A double-decker bus has two floors, one on top of the other.

Background you need

The WNBA is the top professional women's basketball league in the United States.

A championship parade is a public celebration where a winning team rides through a city so fans can cheer them.

A mascot is a character that represents a team and entertains the crowd.

In Norse mythology, Valkyries are warrior women from old stories, and ravens are often linked to them.

Break it down

LEAD: The Golden State Valkyries celebrate their WNBA title with a Bay Area parade
KEY EVENT: Championship parade from Oakland to San Francisco
  +- WHO: The Valkyries players, mascot Vi and fans
  +- WHERE: Jack London Square, the Ferry Building and Oracle Park
  +- WHEN: Wednesday
EVIDENCE: The team won the title in Year 2 after reaching the playoffs in its first year
OPEN QUESTION: How will the young team follow up its fast rise?

Why it matters

A new team winning so fast shows that newcomers can beat the odds, and the parade lets a whole community celebrate together.

Test what you remember

1. Where did the Valkyries' celebration begin?

- (A) The Ferry Building in San Francisco
- (B) The team's practice facility in San Francisco
- (C) Jack London Square in Oakland
- (D) Oracle Park in San Francisco

2. What animal is the mascot Vi?

- (A) A raven
- (B) A lion
- (C) An eagle
- (D) A bear

3. How did the players travel across the bay?

- (A) By train
- (B) By bus
- (C) By ferry
- (D) By plane

4. In which year of the team did the Valkyries win the title?

- (A) Year 1
- (B) Year 3
- (C) Year 2
- (D) Year 5

5. Who made the "too small" hand gesture first in Game 3?

- (A) Kiah Stokes of the Valkyries
- (B) Tiffany Hayes of the Valkyries
- (C) Juste Jocyte of the Valkyries
- (D) Angel Reese of Atlanta

6. What did owner Joe Lacob promise when the team started?

- (A) A mascot within five years
- (B) A new arena within five years
- (C) A parade within five years
- (D) A championship within five years

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):